The need for fast action was underlined by the cold-blooded murder of a sixty-nine-year-old American passenger, wheelchair-bound Leon Klinghoffer. After the Palestinians shot him to death, they casually dumped his body at sea.

Although planning for their mission was nearly complete, the team of navy Seals never got the chance to launch the rescue effort. The hijackers, possibly convinced that they had made their point, directed the cruise ship to Port Said in Egypt, where it had been headed before the seizure. There they surrendered to Egyptian officials. Via diplomatic channels, we urgently requested Egypt to turn the hijackers over to U.S. or Italian authorities for prosecution. But President Mubarak announced that they had already been turned over to representatives of the PLO, who had taken them out of Egypt.

The following day, I went to Chicago to make two previously scheduled speeches. While I was there, I was told that the hijackers were still in Egypt, and that an Egyptian airliner was being readied to take the hijackers to Tunisia and a heroes' reception by the PLO. Through intelligence means, we learned exactly when it was scheduled to leave.

As Air Force One left Chicago for the trip back to Washington, I approved a plan calling for U.S. fighter planes to intercept the airliner and force it to land at a U.S. base in the Mediterranean; we would then either bring the hijackers to America or turn them over to Italy for prosecution. "Of course," I wrote in my diary as Air Force One headed east, "we will not attack the plane, just signal it to turn and crowd it a bit."

This time, I thought, we really had a chance to bring some terrorists to justice. Fortunately, I was right.

At almost the same time that Air Force One was landing at Andrews Air Force Base outside Washington, four Navy F-14's from the aircraft carrier *Saratoga* intercepted the